

Raffaele "Raf" Vitale

Senior Product Designer – AI Systems & Interaction Models

Toronto, Canada | London, UK (relocating 2026)

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Summary

Senior Product Designer specializing in AI-native systems and interaction models. Proven ability to design for probabilistic behavior, prototype AI responses to validate trust mechanisms and edge cases, and shape product strategy in high-ambiguity environments where traditional patterns don't apply. Technical fluency with how AI models behave, fail, and evolve over time. Comfortable working at the intersection of product, research, and engineering to define what should exist, not only how it looks.

Experience

Walmart Global Tech - Walmart Seller - walmart.com

Senior Product Designer – AI Recommendation Systems | 2025 – Present

Designing AI-powered recommendation systems at marketplace scale, focusing on trust, transparency, and adoption for seller-facing tools.

- Leading UX for SuccessHub, consolidating multiple AI recommendation surfaces into a unified decision-making experience that helps sellers understand and act on automated insights
 - Designing for trust in AI recommendations by making model reasoning visible and actionable—translating complex data science outputs into clear, contextual guidance that drives seller adoption
 - Prototyping recommendation acceptance flows to test how sellers respond to AI-generated insights, validating trust mechanisms before full rollout
 - Partnering with product, engineering, and data science teams to shape how AI recommendations surface across mobile and web, balancing automation with user control
 - Reducing friction in multi-step workflows where sellers need to understand *why* the system suggests an action before committing
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Obvious

Senior Product Designer – AI Systems | 2025

Designed interaction models for LLM-powered systems, shaping how users collaborate with AI through Skills mode and continuous learning frameworks.

- Prototyped agent behavior to test edge cases, failure states, and trust-building patterns before implementation—using prototypes as decision tools to validate product direction with founders and engineering
 - Shaped product strategy around Skills-based frameworks that enabled users to teach the system new capabilities, balancing model autonomy with user control and transparency
 - Designed interaction models for continuous learning systems where the AI evolved based on user feedback, creating interfaces that supported correction, refinement, and trust over time
 - Designed for probabilistic AI behavior rather than deterministic outcomes, establishing patterns for how users understand and collaborate with systems that learn
 - Partnered closely with engineering to understand model constraints and translate technical limitations into coherent user experiences
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Theoriq

Founding Product Designer – AI & Crypto Agents | 2024 – 2025

Owned end-to-end UX for AI agents operating with real assets in high-stakes environments where trust and governance were non-negotiable.

- Designed governable agent workflows by prototyping decision-making flows to simulate model responses and validate trust mechanisms before deployment
 - Defined interaction paradigms for autonomous systems where users needed visibility into agent reasoning without micromanaging execution—balancing transparency with cognitive load
 - Partnered with CEO and founding team to translate experimental AI infrastructure into product vision, making complex agent behavior legible to non-technical users
 - Advocated for responsible design choices around agent autonomy, establishing guardrails that preserved user agency while enabling system capability
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Voiceflow

Senior Product Designer – AI Agents | 2025

Worked with executive leadership to improve onboarding and activation for AI agent workflows, focusing on mental model clarity for non-technical users.

- Reduced time-to-value for first-time users by clarifying mental models around agent creation and execution through iterative prototyping and validation
 - Designed interaction patterns that made LLM behavior predictable and trustworthy, helping users understand when agents would succeed or fail
 - Established product direction for early-stage AI surfaces by synthesizing user research into design principles that guided feature prioritization
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Coinbase – Developer Platform

Senior Product Designer – Developer Tools (Contract) | 2025

Designed developer-facing experiences for querying indexed blockchain data, focusing on reducing cognitive load in complex technical workflows.

- Designed SQL-based query interfaces informed by developer interviews and task analysis, optimizing for discoverability and error prevention
 - Contributed to Pay with USDC platform surfaces, prioritizing clarity and trust in financial interactions where mistakes are costly
 - Collaborated with engineering to understand API constraints and design within technical realities rather than idealized flows
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CurbCutOS

Product Design Lead – SaaS Accessibility | 2023 – 2024

Led transition from consulting-led services to a scalable accessibility SaaS platform, designing systems that automated compliance testing at scale.

- Established design system and automated accessibility testing workflows that enabled teams to ship compliant features without manual audits
 - Designed for automation and trust—creating interfaces where users understood what the system validated and where human judgment was still needed
 - Reduced manual audit time by 60% through integrated testing flows, applying systems thinking to make accessibility validation scalable across enterprise customers
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Zalando SE (now Partner)

Senior Product Designer – Design Systems | 2021 – 2022

Contributed to the first B2B design system supporting multiple marketplace verticals, focusing on scalable patterns and cross-team consistency.

- Designed reusable component libraries and standards that improved development efficiency and enabled consistent experiences across partner and internal tooling
 - Applied systems thinking to design patterns that needed to work across diverse use cases and technical constraints
 - Collaborated with engineering to scale system adoption, balancing flexibility with consistency across multiple product surfaces
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Independent / Studio Work (Selected)

Independent Product Designer | 2016 – Present

Led product and system design engagements for early-stage startups and embedded product teams. Delivered AI-native UX, design systems, and rapid prototypes across SaaS, developer tools, and crypto.

Selected clients: Walmart, Obvious.ai, Coinbase (contract), Zalando, Travelnest, Frequency (Berachain), Graceview.ai, JazzX AI (Microsoft), CurbCutOS, Artscapy, Kerubin.

Skills & Expertise

AI-Native Product Design

Designing for probabilistic behavior and model uncertainty · Prototyping AI responses and edge cases as decision tools · Trust-building in autonomous systems · Interaction models for conversational and agent-based AI · Designing for model evolution and continuous learning · Responsible AI advocacy

Technical Fluency & Collaboration

Understanding how AI models behave and fail · Working with research and engineering on model constraints · React/Tailwind prototyping for AI interactions · API-aware design for LLM-powered systems · Cross-functional influence through reasoning and narrative

Tools & Craft

Figma (advanced prototyping, variants, tokens) · Interactive prototyping (ProtoPie, Framer, code) · React, Tailwind, Framer Motion · LLM tooling and prompt systems · AI development tools (Cursor, Claude Code)

Education

Apple Developer Academy – UX / UI Design, Naples, Italy

ILAS Design School – Diploma with Honors

References

Available upon request.

Former managers and partners include senior leaders from Walmart, Obvious.ai, Coinbase, Voiceflow, TheorIQ, Zalando, and CurbCutOS.